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THE DEARBORN INDEPENDENT

By the
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Must We Freeze This Winter?

A comprehensive investigation of the bituminous and anthracite coal situation by a staff writer of The Dearborn Independent reveals that at this time there appears to be little likelihood of the coal output this year catching up with the needs of the nation.

Plenty of Coal—In the Earth

That is the way the situation shapes up. With more than half the world's coal supply in its mines, and nearly half the world's coal output to its credit

The U. S. Can't Fill Its Bins

The article dealing with this subject is the first of several which will discuss and analyze the predicament in which this country finds itself today. Frantic bidding now going on is rapidly running up the price of fuel which is obtainable.

—Turn to pages 14 and 15.

Asbury Lever—Who Is Not Afraid

IT TAKES nerve for a man to get up before an audience and tell them unpleasant truths about themselves and their State. It is only now and then that a man has the quality of mental make-up to get by with that sort of thing.

South Carolina is proud of a son of that caliber.

He is Asbury Francis Lever.

It would be a great thing for the country if more states had such men, because there are many unpleasant facts that ought to be told.

Mr. Lever, who is now midway between 40 and 50, has accomplished more during his 45 years than most public men do in a lifetime. After serving a hard apprenticeship as a farm laborer and country school teacher, he became a member of the state legislature. From that position he went to Congress, at the age of 26, where he remained for 18 years, recently resigning to accept an appointment by President Wilson on the Federal Farm Loan Board. During the last six years of his service in Congress, Mr. Lever was chairman of the Committee on Agriculture. He is said to have the distinction of being the author of more constructive and far-reaching agricultural legislation than any man in Congress.

But to return to the unique reputation of this man for telling the people the drab and unvarnished truth—even though it hurts from skin to vital—instead of soft-soaping and blarneying them with decrepit yarns and rosy predictions, here is the way he recently shot it to an audience in his neighboring state of North Carolina:

"Do you men and women know that the average Negro teacher in a great big State like five times as much a day as the average school-teacher of North Carolina?"

"Do you know that the average annual salary of a North Carolina teacher is \$264?"

"Do you know that scrub women and sewer diggers in every city in the country make more than three times as much as you teachers?"

"When you go home tonight ponder over what the influence of the public school-teacher means to your little boys and girls."

"The salary of teachers should be brought to a basis where teaching becomes a profession tempting to the very brightest class of men and women of the country. The training of our children should not be in the hands, as it too often is, of the immature boys and girls. The teacher should be consecrated to the service, but patched britches, the same old dress year after year, and empty stomachs do not tend to consecration."

"The South must awake to its educational backwardness; its every problem must find its solution in the schoolroom. Against the hyphenated American, the Bolshevik and Sovietist, I should feel safe when I felt sure that the citizenship of the country was educated sufficiently to know something of the institutions of the country as compared with the institutions and forms of government of other countries. The great duty ahead of the American people is to put on a campaign that every patriot become a teacher to teach the people plain unadulterated Americanism."

After handing out the above straight-from-the-shoulder philippic on the school conditions, Mr. Lever entered upon a discussion of mud. Differing from many public men, this man never throws this article, yet never misses an opportunity to talk about it. "Our mud tax," he said, "is one of the heaviest drains on the South. This mud tax is paid by the farmer who produces the crops. It is deducted from the price of his products. Let me illustrate. It costs a North Carolina farmer 13 cents to haul 100 pounds of corn a distance of one mile. Illinois, Maryland, New Jersey and Wisconsin farmers can do such hauling at a cost of from five to seven cents. You see, they have solid roads while ours are mud. This same ratio of cost holds good in the hauling to market of such crops as cotton, hay, tobacco and potatoes."

"But, my friends, the financial drain of the mud tax is the least of the burdens it imposes. The human race loves companionship. The contentedness of a community is in proportion to the ease of communication between individuals of the community. Community centers, so vital as a factor in the development of community life, are dependent upon the character of the roads. This is true likewise of the church and educational life of the community."

"Consolidated schools with modern equipment and high grade teachers are impossible in a community of bad and indifferent roads. Roads, religion and education are inseparably linked up as primal factors in the progress of civilization."

"I know the tragedy of the woman who works on a farm. My mother was one of them. The traveler who passes through the South sees the farm woman with her little brood of children picking frost-covered cotton. She will often see such sights and my heart bleeds because of it."

"The greatest problem of this or any other age is that of home ownership. The ownership of a home inspires the desire to conserve. The desire to conserve inspires the wish for orderly procedure. Anarchy, I. W. Wism and such other isms as result from idleness and the lack of anything to conserve cannot thrive

where the bulk of the community owns their own homes.

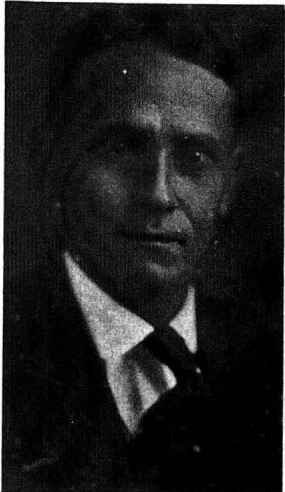
There are two fundamental things wrong with the world. One is idleness; the other the inability of such a large per cent of the people to secure homes on the one hand and upon the other the desire of so many of our city people to escape the responsibility of home ownership. Fortunately, we now have the Federal Reserve System, the Farm Loan System and the Federal Warehouse System. Through these instrumentalities we may now fix forever the economic and social status of our country. Will we do it?"

"But is this only a farmer's problem? Has the banker no concern in the welfare of the farm children? Is not the lawyer, merchant, doctor and every class of society vitally interested in the general leveling up of the rural community? The problem goes to the very vitals of our civilization and everyone must be interested in that."

"The farmer must not look on it as his fight alone. The old idea of winning the battle with signs, passwords and grips will not do. Too often this proves ineffective. The problem of every class is the problem of every other class in a community. When smallpox breaks out in a settlement a quarantine is quickly thrown around the vicinity. It is not to protect the victim, but the settlement. The financial independence of the South with all that means in her development in every direction is a problem of all the South. Suspicion as between classes

must give way to co-operative spirit. Group thinking is a most dangerous tendency developed out of the war. We must begin to think in terms of brotherly helpfulness."

"My advice to the farmers of the South is to bunch their fire. Use a choke bore gun. Do not try to do too many things at once. Rome was not built in a day. There will be many pressing problems when we are all dead and gone. Do not put too many eggs under the old hen."



ASBURY FRANCIS LEVER

Fights Liquor and Collects Books



E. H. CHERRINGTON

HERE is the man who speaks of \$62,000,000 without batting an eye. He is executive secretary of the World League Against Alcoholism, and it will take that amount, he says, to carry on the campaign for prohibition in the next five years.

This is \$12,000,000 more than the total cost of national prohibition, according to the figures of the Anti-Saloon League for its twenty-five-year fight. E. H. Cherrington is still a young man, and he finds time for a lot of activities besides directing dry campaigns. Books are his hobby, and the walls of his home are lined with them. In addition, he displays shrewd business sense in dealing in real estate.

Homes of Prehistoric Folk to Be Explored

AN EXPEDITION of scientific students has been made up in California and Oregon to explore thoroughly the channel islands off that part of the coast in California known as Santa Barbara and Ventura counties during the next six months. The party is to be sustained by Stanford University largely and to a less extent by several denominational colleges in Southern California. Anthropological and archaeological students, who have spent several weeks each on these islands, say they are one of the very richest fields for work in that department of knowledge on the Pacific Coast.

The channel islands constitute California's only archipelago, with the possible exceptions of the rocky and scanty Farallone Islands. They have been objects of romance, legends, curiosity and mystery for a generation.

The islands are within eighty-two miles of California's shore, yet are unfrequented, and years roll by with visits to them of less than fifty persons annually. Each island has its own particular strange, uncanny traditions of the tribes of red men, and each has the countless traces of an occupation by thousands and thousands of Indians.

When Juan Rodriguez Cabrillo, the Portuguese navigator, sailed up the coast of California in 1542, he stopped for a day or two at each of the channel islands, and his records bear testimony that on the islands of Santa Barbara, Catalina, Clemente and St. Nicholas there were a "vigorous and lusty race of natives, who thronged the shores of the little bays and headlands," and gazed in mute wonder at the white-sailed ship of the navigators.

Today the islands stand as they did more than 350 years ago, but the natives are only a memory, represented by immense quantities of stone implements, barrels of fine wampum and carload of human bones. St. Nicholas Island lies eighty miles immediately opposite the little city of San Buenaventura (recently called by the more modern and easy name of Ventura) and is the most interesting of all the channel islands from many points of view. As far back as the memory of any person in Southern California extends, hundreds of white skeletons have dotted the valleys and hillsides. Strange utensils of serpentine sandstone and stearite are found among the human bones, and the island and its erstwhile inhabitants have a history so curious that it is difficult of comprehension.

In 1835 the Franciscan padre in the Santa Barbara mission, learning that there were but sixteen of the strange and almost extinct human race then living there, determined to rescue them from the island. They went over in a sloop and succeeded, as they thought, in getting all on board.

At the last moment an Indian woman returned for her child and one of the frequent storms of the channel islands springing up, the sloop was driven away without her. The sloop went on the rocks of Point Conception and was wrecked.

Sixteen years later Captain George Nidever and two men went from the coast on a sloop to hunt otter off St. Nicholas. On landing they were, like Crusoe, astonished to discover human footprints in the sand. They saw no one, however, and a storm compelled them to put to sea. It was two years thereafter that the venturous captain, revolving in his mind the sight of the footprints on the uncanny island, determined to go back and bring over the lonely woman of whom he had vaguely heard. Men accompanied him and at length they saw on the surf-beaten shore a woman with long tawny hair, dressed in a queer garb of colored bird skins and scraping with a bone knife vegetables from a sea. They surrounded and approached her stealthily, and although suddenly confronted she did not appear in the least afraid but smiled, and then, falling on her knees, prayed to the sun. The wild woman offered no objection when by signs she was made to understand that she was to go with them in the boat.

They reached the Santa Barbara across the rough sea, and the first thing the Indian woman saw was a man riding a horse. She had never seen nor heard of any object like it, and thought the man and horse were one, and she knelt on the shore and offered her devotions to it. Two weeks afterward the last inhabitant of rock-ribbed, tempest-tossed St. Nicholas died from eating food to which she was unaccustomed, furnished by her rescuers, and the curtains fell on her career. The woman, known as the "Lone Woman of St. Nicholas," has been the subject of a score of romances and poems.

St. Nicholas is ten miles long and four miles wide at the widest point. Its topography shows a nearly level plateau, with an elevation of 800 to 1,000 feet. Two-thirds of the surface is covered with scattered sand, and the remainder grows a species of nutritious grass and moss, on which a thousand sheep find pasture.

As far as the eye can trace there are barren levels with innumerable circular depressions, showing where primitive dwellings once stood. Not a vestige remains of the materials used in the construction of these ranches. Hundreds of shell mounds are scattered about and are found to consist of astonishing numbers of Mollusca, the bones of every species of fish found in the channel, skeletons of seals, sea elephants, whales, sea otter, the island fox and various aquatic birds.

An examination of some mounds discloses all sorts of curious utensils—stone cooking pots, ollas, mortars, pestles, drills, bone needles, arrowheads, shell beads, charm stones, pipes, cups and a few arrowheads, spear points, and swords made of bone. The absence of many weapons proves the peaceful attributes of the islanders. Small imitations of boats and fish carved from crystallized talc and serpentine also show a rudimentary knowledge of the art of sculpture.

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